

COINPICKS · RESEARCH & EDUCATION

Iran War Risk Pillar Report

Middle East Conflict Risk — Researched, Scored, and Personally Committed

*Originally written June 19, 2026; scores committed by me June 19, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8 and July 10, 2026 against live primary sources; given a light 1-day re-check on July 11, 2026 — the re-rated scores in this version are **DRAFT**, awaiting my stamp.*

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 25% OF MY THESIS

Written June 19, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified July 11, 2026 · Not Financial Advice

The Scores — Committed vs. Drafts

June column committed by me June 19, 2026 · Jul 8 / Jul 10 drafts shown for lineage · Jul 11 draft re-rated from a light 1-day re-check — awaiting my stamp

WINDOW	MY JUNE P	JUL 8	JUL 10	JUL 11	QUALITY	IMPACT	SIGNAL	MY CALL
1 month	50	40	42	44	0.60	8	-0.6	Mild Bear — no new strikes, but MoU still "over"
3 months	55	47	49	50	0.65	8	0.0	Neutral
6 months	62	55	56	57	0.70	8	+0.8	Mild Bull
1 year	75	70	70	70	0.65	8	+2.1	Bull (dip-buy, delayed)
3 years	85	83	83	83	0.55	8	+2.9	Bull

Draft P (Jul 11): 44 / 50 / 57 / 70 / 83 · **Weight:** 20% (equal) · **Impact:** 8 (uniform) · **Formula:** Signal = ((P – 50) ÷ 50) × Quality × Impact. Lineage: June committed 50 / 55 / 62 / 75 / 85 (June 19, 2026) → July 8 draft 40 / 47 / 55 / 70 / 83 → July 10 draft 42 / 49 / 56 / 70 / 83 → July 11 draft — awaiting my stamp.

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

P — the odds this is *good for crypto* by then. Near-term nudged further up but still below a coin flip: no new US or Iranian strikes have been reported since July 8–9, Iran's foreign minister is in Oman actively discussing the Strait of Hormuz, and US officials expect Iran to publicly state the strait is open and vessels are safe "in the coming days." That statement hasn't landed yet, Iran has separately asserted it will only guarantee safe passage for ships that coordinate with Tehran (a conditional, not clean, signal), and Trump still calls the MoU "over" while threatening to "completely decimate" Iran if its leadership targets him. Long-term still high — these same two sides walked back from the brink twice this year (April 8, June 8), and war shocks have historically faded.

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. Today's check is lighter than July 10's: the "no new strikes" and "Oman talks" facts are multi-outlet confirmed (CNN's live blog, Al Jazeera), but the deeper facts on Hormuz insurance rates, the odds board, and the diplomatic sequencing weren't re-verified from scratch today — they carry forward from July 10. Quality still tops at 0.70 and falls to 0.55 on the long-dated windows given the thin sample.

Impact — 8 out of 10, the uniform value shared by every pillar in the equal-weight model. BTC has now held its post-strike bounce for a third straight session near \$64K. A war shock hits crypto hard for days — but it stays one input among many.

The Claim

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated July 11, 2026

The crowd: still cautious but the tape has gone quiet — no new US or Iranian strikes reported since the July 8–9 exchanges. Trump still says the MoU is "over" and has threatened to "completely decimate" Iran if its leadership targets him personally; Iran's Foreign Minister Araghchi is in Oman working the Hormuz question. The strait still sits at elevated risk pending Iran's expected (but not yet delivered) public statement on safe passage.

Me: near-term I'm still with the bears but less so — 44% good-for-crypto at 1 month, up from 42% on July 10, because two quiet days plus active mediation is genuine (if unconfirmed) progress. The arc holds: 83% over three

years. The dip is still a buy — it just isn't fully formed yet.

My edge: unchanged from July 10 — the market is pricing de-escalation (Brent stable near \$76.56, not spiking on the still-open MoU-"over" rhetoric), and BTC has now held its bounce for a third session near \$64K. The risk isn't the headlines the crowd fears; it's the quiet paths — a US-casualty event, a formal MoU death by ~Aug 16, a confirmed full Hormuz closure, or Iran's safe-passage statement failing to materialize. I watch those, not the noise.

The Facts

As of July 11, 2026 — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. Facts below carry forward from July 10 except where marked ★ new; today's re-check was light.

- ★ **NEW — no new strikes reported for a second straight day; diplomacy visibly active.** Iran's Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi is in Oman discussing the Strait of Hormuz (CNN live blog, July 11); senior US officials say Washington expects Tehran to issue a public statement "in the coming days" that the strait is open and commercial vessels won't be attacked — not yet delivered as of this writing. Trump again declared the MoU "over" but said talks would continue, and separately threatened to "completely decimate and destroy all areas" of Iran if its leadership targets him personally.
- ★ **NEW, mixed signal — Iran reasserted conditional control over Hormuz,** warning that safe passage can only be guaranteed for vessels that coordinate with Tehran — short of the unconditional "strait is open" statement US officials say they're expecting.
- ★ **NEW — oil essentially flat, not spiking:** Brent held above \$76/bbl through July 10 and traded ~\$76.56 on July 10–11 (+0.7% intraday) — UAE raised crude production to a record high even as Hormuz tanker traffic remains reduced. No fresh escalation premium.
- ★ **NEW — BTC bounce held a third session:** price near \$64,128 on July 11, continuing the post-strike recovery; not independently re-attributed today (July 10's read was chips/yen/dollar, not Iran).
- **Not re-verified today (carried forward from July 10, no evidence of change):** Hormuz insurance rates (2–6% of hull value), the JMIC "severe" advisory status, the Polymarket/odds board figures, and the detailed July 8–9 strike/retaliation tallies below.
- **Second strike wave, July 9 (background, unchanged):** after ~80 targets on July 8 (Sirik, Qeshm Island, Bandar Abbas area), CENTCOM struck ~**90 more targets** early July 9 — second consecutive night, ~**170 cumulative** — across Tehran, Bandar Abbas, Bushehr province, Chabahar port, and Iranshahr airport, plus, for the first time since April, **bridges** (railway bridges on the Tehran–Mashhad route / Golestan province). Stated rationale: "degrade ability to threaten freedom of navigation." Iranian Health Ministry: **14 killed, 78 wounded** over the two days (incl. 3 killed at a Sirik fishing pier).
- ★ **Iranian retaliation, July 9 — wider geography, near-zero effect:** IRGC/army drones and missiles at **four countries:** Kuwait (Arifjan / Ali Al Salem — a Patriot battery targeted; 3 ballistic + 1 cruise missile + 10 drones **all intercepted**; 1 person injured, stable), Bahrain (Juffair / Sheikh Isa fuel depots — intercepted), Qatar (early-warning/satellite sites — no impacts reported), and **Jordan — first time since the June 11 Azraq strikes: 10 ballistic missiles at Al Azraq Air Base, 8 intercepted, zero casualties or damage.**
- ★ **Zero US casualties either day** — the single most important non-escalation fact of the week (the one Kuwait injury was not specified as US personnel).
- ★ **Friday July 10 — a contested lull: no US-confirmed strike wave overnight Thursday–Friday, but Iranian state media reported fresh US strikes near Asaluyeh (South Pars energy hub) — unconfirmed by the US, with outlets explicitly flagging conflicting reports on any pause. Some US-official-attributed reporting describes a deliberate strike-then-pause posture to let diplomacy work. Trump, Friday: Iran "asked us to continue 'talks.' We have agreed to do so... but the Cease Fire is OVER!"**
- ★ **Khamenei buried; talks may resume July 11:** Khamenei was buried early Friday July 10 at the Imam Reza shrine, Mashhad (some July 9 wires said July 9 — dating conflict noted; July 10 is the later/primary

- report). Talks are reported to resume **July 11** — *Al Arabiya via a Times of Israel liveblog: single-source relay, not confirmed by Qatar or State*. Qatari negotiators traveled to Tehran in coordination with the US, and a mediator swarm has been active since Wednesday (Qatar PM–Araghchi call, Pakistan, Turkey, Egypt, Saudi Arabia, UN Guterres).
- ★ **No formal MoU withdrawal by either side** (explicit as of July 10). Iran calls the US strikes a "gross war crime" and an MoU violation and says it won't negotiate under attack — yet per Trump it requested continued talks. The 60-day window to ~**Aug 16** is intact. (Signing date: June 17 "Islamabad MoU" per the better-sourced reports; one outlet says June 14 — conflict noted.)
 - ★ **Hormuz — worst readings of the crisis:** the US Navy-led JMIC raised its transit advisory from "substantial" to "severe" — the highest tier, "deliberate hostile action" likely. Thursday traffic "virtually ground to a halt" (Insurance Journal); volume estimates conflict — ~50% of pre-war (Al Jazeera) vs a ~92% drop (Sunday Guardian, weaker source) — with transponders off obscuring the truth. War-risk cover now **2–6% of hull value** (vs ~3% on July 8; wartime peak 10%), quotes priced hours before transit; syndicates advising a freeze on bookings west of the strait. The US publicly insists Iran "does not control" the strait. Background: Iran declared the strait shut ~June 22; pre-attack throughput was ~39–41% of pre-crisis per the unofficial straits.live tracker — *single-source*.
 - ★ **Oil FELL despite 170 targets struck — de-escalation being priced:** Brent ~\$78.02 July 8 → ~\$76.3–77.0 July 9 (settle \$76.30 per CNBC; TradingEconomics \$76.97) → ~\$76.00–76.80 **July 10** (–\$2.45 d/d per Fortune's 6:15am ET print — that delta and the ~\$77 July 9 level reference different snapshots); WTI under \$72. Attribution: the pause plus talks hopes. Brent never took out the ~\$80 June 19 baseline.
 - ★ **BTC decoupled and rallied:** July 9 it held above \$62K with a "muted reaction" while oil rose and gold fell; **July 10 it rose +3.5% to near \$64K** (intraday low ~\$61,850), +4.2% on the week (7-day per CoinDesk; Fri–Fri trackers show ~+2.8%), ~\$28B volume; ETH \$1,760 (+2.6%). Attribution per CoinDesk: Asian chip/AI rally, yen +0.6%, weak dollar, liquidation-driven reversal — **explicitly not Iran-driven**. (That is a market move plus reporter attribution, not an institutional estimate.)
 - **Oil re-sanctioned — wind-down on track:** Treasury revoked the MoU oil waiver July 7 (GL X → GL X1): no new Iranian oil sales; in-process deals get grace to **July 17**, proceeds into blocked interest-bearing accounts; China/India refiners re-exposed to secondary sanctions. No new developments July 9–10.
 - **How this round started — tanker attacks, night of July 6–7:** the IRGC fired ≥2 missiles at commercial ships in/near the Strait of Hormuz. Two merchant vessels hit that night: Qatari LNG carrier **Al Rekayyat** (struck ~8nm off Limah, Oman — engine-room fire, crew abandoned ship) and Saudi crude tanker **Wedyan** (damaged); a third vessel was hit within 24 hours — **three hit in total** — and four more tankers turned back. Tehran did not officially claim responsibility.
 - **The pattern:** on **June 27** an Iranian one-way attack drone hit the tanker **M/T Kiku** (Panama-flagged, 2M+ bbl of crude); the US struck targets in Iran the same day, and the IRGC hit US sites in Kuwait and Bahrain on June 28. The ceasefire has now cracked at least **three times** since April (June 7–8, June 27–28, July 6–9) — the rounds getting closer together and bigger.
 - **Diplomacy background:** indirect technical talks in **Doha, June 30–July 2** ended with "positive progress" claimed but no breakthrough; two concrete outcomes — agreement to release the first **\$3B tranche** of ~\$6B in Qatar-held frozen Iranian funds, and an MoU-violations reporting channel. Sticking points: Hormuz transit fees (Iran: will "definitely" charge; US rejects) and the rest of the frozen funds.
 - **Israel is out of this round:** no direct Israel–Iran exchange since June 7–8, and Israel was not a participant in the July 7–9 strikes (Netanyahu visited Haifa naval base July 7, "eye to eye" with Trump). A July 10 Times of Israel liveblog report of Israel joining the strikes is *single-source and unconfirmed* — *treat as rumor*. Israel–Hezbollah simmers on (Rubio announced an Israel–Lebanon "framework deal" June 26) but is not the July driver.

- **The odds:** Polymarket "US invades Iran before 2027" last verified at **14.5%** (up from 11.5% on the strikes) — *a ~July 8 print; no fresh July 10 print obtained, label stale*. "Hormuz traffic normal by July" collapsed to **4.5%**; "regime falls in 2026" ~2.45% (both ~July 8–9, secondhand). "MoU withdrawal by Aug 15" (26% on July 8) and "final deal by Dec 31" (35.5% on July 8): *current prints unverified — Polymarket pages unfetchable July 10*.
- **The baseline (still true, still load-bearing):** June 2025 "12-Day War" — BTC dipped to a **~\$98,225 intraday low (June 22, 2025)**, reclaimed \$107k+ by June 25, a fast V. The far larger 2026 regime-change war (**Feb 28 → Apr 8, 2026**; Khamenei killed Feb 28, confirmed by Iran March 1) still didn't crater crypto on Iran-specific grounds.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The upside is still the **"buy-the-invasion" rebound**. Anchors: Russia–Ukraine (Feb 24, 2022) — BTC fell ~8% to a **~\$34,300 intraday low**, posted a +14.5% up-day on Feb 28, ended **~+25–29% above the low within a week** (~+38% by late March). June 2025 rhymed: ~\$98k dip, fully recovered within a week.

The live test just returned its first reading: July 8's escalation bought only a ~2–3% dip to ~\$61.7k, and BTC has now held near **\$64K for a third straight session (July 9–11)** — though that rally is attributed to chips, the yen, and liquidations, not an Iran V, so don't score it as one. A desensitized market means shallower dips and smaller Vs. The bigger prize is the settlement scenario: a signed deal plus the reported ~\$300B reconstruction fund re-pricing the whole region after oil re-sanctioning. Still a thin sample; the Prize doesn't feed the math — it tells you what the lean is worth acting on.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case this is wrong

- **BTC is a risk asset here, not a safe haven — and the oil-shock path still has numbers.** Goldman's April scenario: Brent averages **>\$100 in 2026** if Hormuz stays largely shut another month (\$120 Q3 / \$115 Q4); JPMorgan: **\$120–130** if disruption persists through Q3, **~\$150** in a full-closure worst case. Brent at ~\$76 today doesn't retire those scenarios — the strait is on a "severe" advisory with traffic at crisis lows; if that persists, the inflation shock arrives late, not never, and crypto falls *with* equities.
- **It keeps breaking.** The ceasefire has now cracked at least three times since April — June 7–8, June 27–28, and the July 6–9 round that grew to ~170 targets and put bridges on the target list for the first time since April. The rounds are getting closer together and bigger. Each one, "time heals" gets directly contradicted.
- **The rally may be complacency, not resilience.** BTC rising through 170 strikes proves nothing about Iran — the move is attributed to chips and the yen. The market is pricing a contained flare-up (Brent \$76, below the June baseline); that pricing is fragile to a US-casualty event, a formal MoU withdrawal, or a confirmed full closure — any one repricing gaps down, not drifts.
- **Thin sample, still.** The bullish long-term read rests on ~2 dip-and-recover events, both in a bull regime — geopolitical shocks don't always V-recover.

The Triggers

Dated events ahead — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Reset July 11, 2026

DATE	EVENT	MEANS
Coming days	Iran expected to publicly state Hormuz is open / vessels safe (per US officials, not yet delivered; Iran has so far only offered conditional safe-passage language)	Statement delivered = clear near-term de-escalation, re-rate 1-month up; continued silence or conditional-only stance = re-rate flat to down
Ongoing	Oman-mediated Iran–US talks on Hormuz (Araghchi in Muscat as of July 11)	Progress reported = off-ramp reopening; talks stall = back to strike-pause-strike risk
July 17, 2026	Iranian oil-sale waiver wind-down completes (GL X1, revoked July 7)	Sanctions bite — Tehran's pressure to escalate or deal rises
By ~Aug 16, 2026	Formal MoU withdrawal or 60-day window expires unsigned (Polymarket withdrawal odds last verified 26% on July 8 — current print unverified)	Diplomacy dead — re-rate 1/3/6-month down
Any time	Confirmed full Hormuz closure / Brent through \$90	Oil shock confirmed — re-rate near-term down hard
Any time	US-casualty event (Bahrain/Kuwait/Qatar/Jordan bases, Gulf shipping)	Escalation spiral — re-rate down hard
By Dec 31, 2026	Final US–Iran nuclear deal signed (Polymarket last verified 35.5% on July 8 — current print unverified)	De-escalation confirmed — re-rate up across windows

The flip line: a US invasion / regime-change round two, or a sustained *full* Hormuz closure with Brent north of \$100 = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken. June's flip line was "wider war + Hormuz oil shock" — as of July 11 we are still halfway there: the strait's advisory status hasn't been re-verified today, but Brent is stable at ~\$76.5, *below* the June baseline, and two days have now passed without a new strike. A contained strike-pause-strike loop that burns out keeps the long-term Bull.

My Decision

🕒 **UPDATED DRAFT — JULY 11, 2026 · AWAITING MY STAMP**

Draft P: 44 / 50 / 57 / 70 / 83 · My Weight: 20% (equal) · Impact: 8 (uniform)

The June committed scores (50 / 55 / 62 / 75 / 85, committed June 19, 2026) remain the last human-stamped values. This draft nudges the near windows up off July 10 (42 / 49 / 56 → 44 / 50 / 57): a second straight day without a new strike, and active Oman-mediated talks specifically on Hormuz, are genuine (if modest and unconfirmed) progress. Offsetting that: Iran's own language on safe passage is still conditional, not the clean "strait is open" statement US officials say they expect, and Trump's MoU-"over" rhetoric persists. The long arc holds at 70 / 83.

Still a **dip-watching pillar, not a panic-selling one** — the 1-month lean stays Mild Bear because a strike-pause-strike regime can still re-fire any night. The 3-month window crosses to a genuine coin flip. The accident paths into ~Aug 16 remain the real risk — watch those, not the headlines.

Override any P and re-stamp — the master blend recomputes.

What Changed Since Last Check

Light re-check July 11, 2026 (previous full re-research July 10, 2026)

- ★ **No new strikes reported for a second straight day.** The July 8-9 exchange (~170 targets struck, four-country retaliation) has not repeated as of July 11 — the longest quiet stretch since the ceasefire first cracked.
- ★ **Diplomacy visibly active:** Iran's FM Araghchi in Oman on Hormuz; US officials expect an Iranian public statement on safe passage "in the coming days" (not yet delivered). Iran has instead reasserted conditional control — safe passage only for coordinating vessels.
- **Trump's posture unchanged:** MoU still "over," talks continuing per his account, plus a new threat to "completely decimate" Iran if its leadership targets him.
- **Oil and BTC both quiet:** Brent ~\$76.56, essentially flat; BTC held its bounce near \$64,128 for a third session.
- **Not re-verified today:** Hormuz insurance rates, the JMIC advisory level, and the odds board all carry forward from July 10 unchanged.
- **Score re-rates (July 10 draft → July 11 draft):** 1mo 42 → 44 — a second quiet day plus active Hormuz-specific mediation, offset by Iran's still-conditional language and Trump's continued "over" rhetoric · 3mo 49 → 50 — crosses to a genuine coin flip · 6mo 56 → 57 — small pull-through · 1yr 70 and 3yr 83 held — two quiet days doesn't move the structural thesis. Draft only — awaiting my stamp.

Sources

Retrieved & graded July 11, 2026 (light re-check; July 10 sources below still stand for facts not re-verified today) — click and judge the quality yourself. Official statements are quoted inside the wire reporting below; then prices, then betting markets (sentiment only).

- **July 11 additions:** CNN live — Araghchi in Oman on Hormuz, Trump MoU "over" + decimate threat, expected Iranian safe-passage statement (Jul 11) · CNBC — Brent context, UAE record production (referenced Jul 11).
- **The escalation (official statements via wire reporting):** NPR — second-night US strikes (July 9) · Bloomberg — attacks traded for second day (July 9) · CENTCOM release — second strike round (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · Al Jazeera — second-night strikes & the peace process (July 9) · Gulf News — Bushehr/Chabahar/Iranshahr strikes, Kuwait intercepts (July 9) · The National — Iran attacks on Gulf states & Jordan (July 9) · RFE/RL — Hormuz/Jordan (403 at retrieval; cited

- via search) · NPR — Hormuz tanker attacks (July 7) · CBS live — Treasury waiver revocation, CENTCOM 80+ targets, IRGC 85-site claim (July 8) · Al Jazeera — Trump "ceasefire over" quotes (July 8).
- **Diplomacy:** Al Jazeera — talks status, no formal MoU withdrawal, Khamenei burial (July 10) · Al Jazeera — mediators urge MoU compliance (July 9) · CNN live — Trump on talks / "Cease Fire is OVER", Qatari team to Tehran (July 10; 451 at retrieval, cited via search) · Times of Israel — July 11 talks date via Al Arabiya (single-source relay, unconfirmed) · Times of Israel liveblog — Israel-join-strikes report (July 10; single-source, unconfirmed) · Al Jazeera — Doha outcomes (July 2).
 - **The oil waiver:** CBS — GL X1 waiver rescission (July 7) · Axios — waiver revocation (July 7) · The Hill — sanctions detail (July 7).
 - **The prices:** Fortune — Brent ~\$76.00–76.80 (July 10) · Kitco/Reuters — oil fell as markets weigh strikes (July 9) · Sunday Guardian — Brent ~\$76 / WTI <\$72 (July 10; weaker source) · CNBC — Brent \$78.02 / WTI \$73.52 (July 8) · Insurance Journal — traffic near halt, war-risk 2–6% of hull value (July 9) · The New Arab — JMIC "severe" advisory · LMA — insurance availability vs safety concerns · *(Hormuz traffic magnitude conflicts across outlets — ~50% of pre-war vs ~92% drop — transponders off; pre-attack throughput figures are from the unofficial straits.live tracker — single-source)* · CoinDesk — BTC steady above \$62K (July 9) · CoinDesk — BTC to ~\$64K on chips/yen, not Iran (July 10) · Fortune — BTC ~\$61.7K (July 6, pre-escalation) · CoinDesk — ~\$450M liquidations (July 8).
 - **The odds (sentiment only, not fact):** Blockchain.News — invasion odds 11.5% → 14.5% (~July 8 print — stale; no fresh July 10 print obtained) · Blockchain.News — Hormuz-normal-by-July odds collapse to 4.5% (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · Polymarket pages unfetchable July 10 — *MoU-withdrawal and deal-by-Dec-31 current prints unverified; last verified July 8: 26% / 35.5%.*